

ABORTION RIGHTS: WHY SEX-SELECTIVE ABORTION CANNOT BE BANNED

Presenters:



BACKGROUND



Financial Stability

Sons responsible for financial support and caregiving for elderly parents, farm labour

Daughters may leave their birth families, offering little financial return

Therefore, having a son ensures financial security and reduces hardship in old age

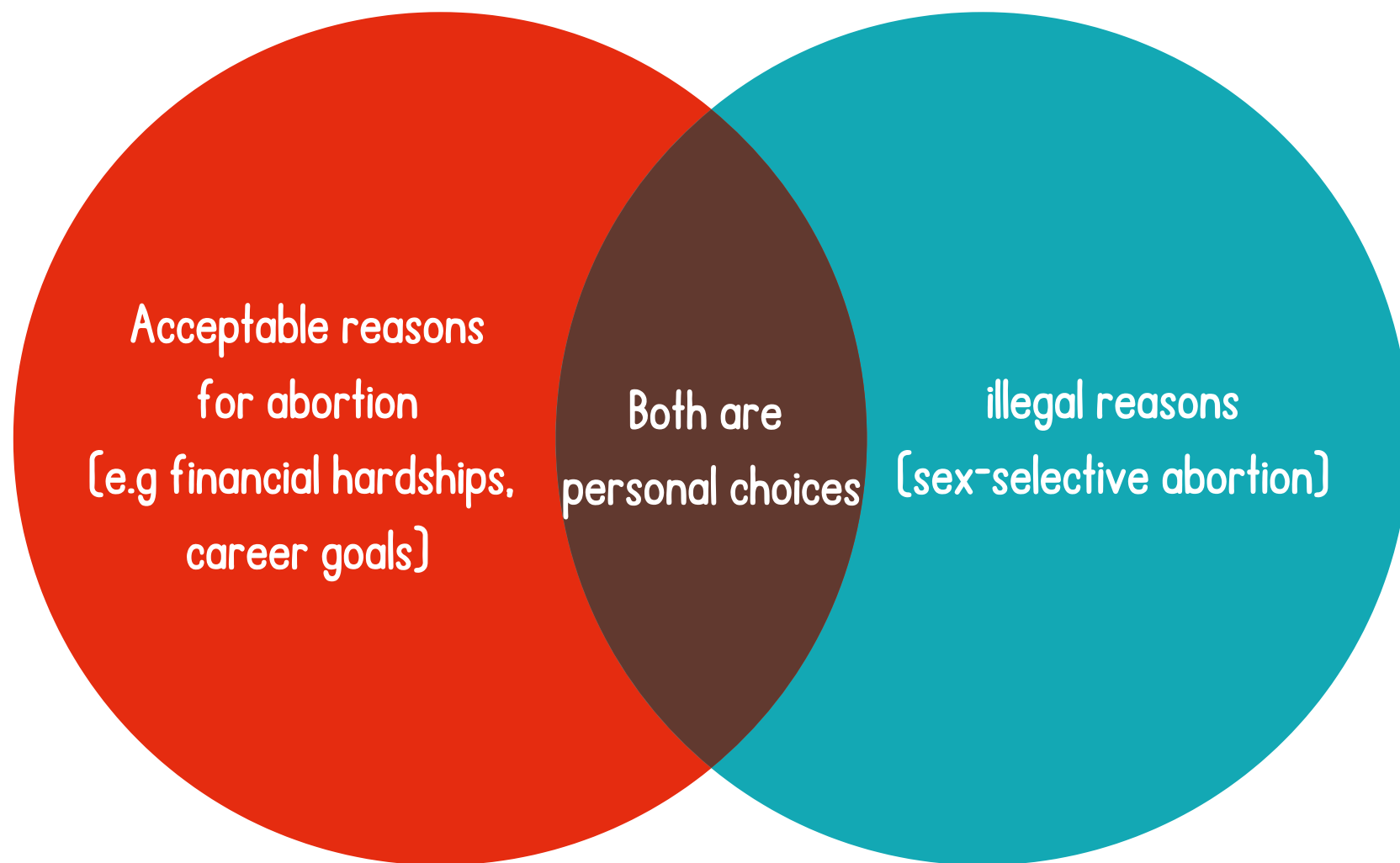
Cultural Considerations

Males carry the family name, inheritance and perform essential religious and ancestral rites

Inability to produce a male heir can bring social stigma, emotional distress

IN SOCIETIES WHERE A CHILD'S GENDER IS STIGMATISED, WOULD BEING RAISED IN SUCH AN ENVIRONMENT TRULY SUPPORT THEIR WELL-BEING?

PREMISE 1: IF ABORTION IS MORALLY JUSTIFIED FOR ANY REASON, THEN IT SHOULD BE MORALLY JUSTIFIED FOR ALL REASONS, INCLUDING SEX SELECTION.

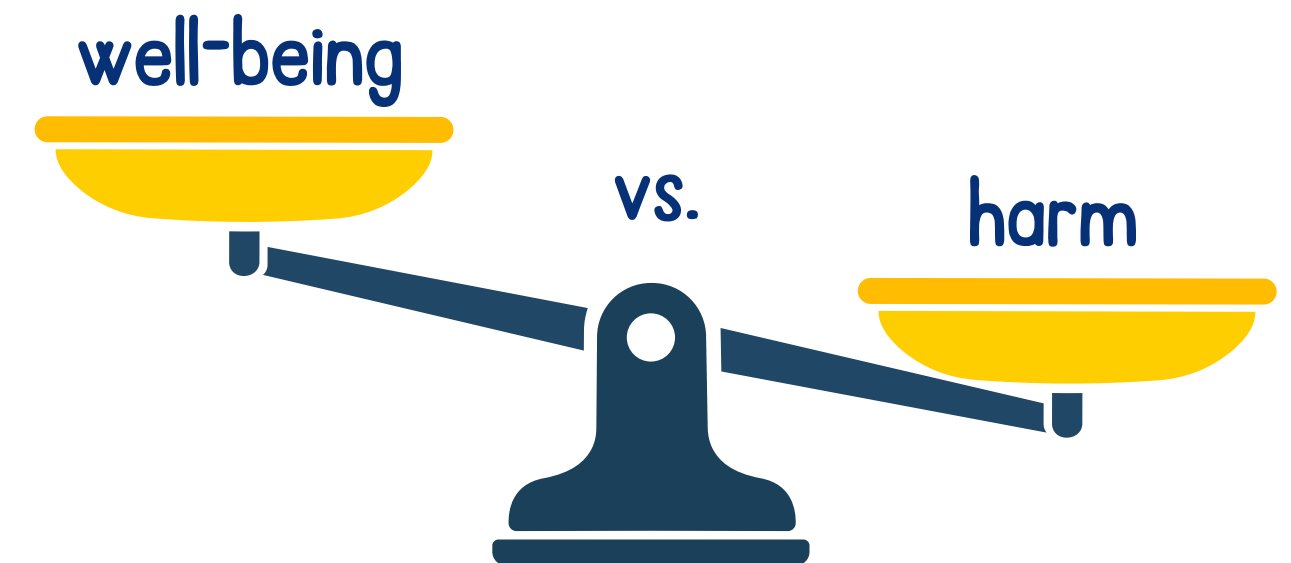


1. Inconsistency in Moral and Legal Reasoning
 - **Inconsistency in Abortion Laws:** If abortion is allowed for financial or personal reasons, banning it for sex selection is contradictory.
 - **Selective Restrictions:** Either all personal reasons for abortion are valid, or none should be.
 - **Broader Reproductive Choices** like IVF is allowed
2. Practical Consequences of Banning Sex-Selective Abortion(SSA)
 - **Unsafe Abortions:** Women turn to illegal, unregulated procedures, risking their health.
 - **Reduced Access to Abortion** as doctors fear legal consequences, limiting abortion services.
 - **Harm to Female Children:** Some families resort to infanticide or neglect, worsening gender bias.

UTILITARIANISM

Utilitarianism: Ethics should maximize well-being and minimize harm

- If abortion is allowed to reduce suffering (e.g., financial hardship), banning SSA contradicts this logic.
- The ban does not stop SSA but increases harm (unsafe abortions, restricted reproductive rights, harm to female children).
- A utilitarian approach prioritizes education and social change over restrictive laws that backfire.



PREMISE 2: PARENTS HAVING THE RIGHT TO DECIDE THE CHARACTERISTICS OF THEIR FAMILY BASED ON PERSONAL PREFERENCES

a) Virtue Ethics

- having a child of a specific gender will help their family live a happier and more harmonious life.

b) Practical Wisdom

- Reflects virtues like responsibility, compassion, care and love, which are essential for well-being of their families and children.

c) Influence of social norms

- Preferences for family composition; sons carry the family name, daughters bring harmony.



OBJECTION 1:

"SEX-SELECTIVE ABORTION REINFORCES GENDER DISCRIMINATION"

Response: The right to abortion should prioritize personal autonomy and family well-being, addressing systemic issues like gender discrimination through education and legal reforms, not by restricting individual choices.

OBJECTION 2:

"PERMITTING SEX-SELECTIVE ABORTION LEADS TO A SLIPPERY SLOPE"

Response: The concern about a slippery slope can be addressed by distinguishing sex-selective abortion from eugenic abortions, focusing on personal autonomy and context, while maintaining legal boundaries to protect reproductive rights and prevent discrimination.



SUMMING UP

- Given abortion is permissible under certain circumstances (e.g., financial problems, personal readiness).
- Premise 1 (Consistency): If abortion is permissible for reasons like financial problems, it should also be permissible for sex selection, as all reproductive choices should be treated equally.
- Premise 2 (Virtue Ethics): Parents have the right to make decisions regarding their family characteristics (including sex selection), as these decisions promote the long-term well-being and flourishing of the family.
- Conclusion: Therefore, sex-selective abortion should be supported, as it aligns with both moral consistency and the ethical principle of virtue ethics.



THANK YOU!!



References

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